

A+Study





Problem

One of the most common problems for College of Engineering students, especially Computer Science students, is time management. A lot of students have many difficult classes per semester because of their majors, and these classes tend to have several in-depth projects and exams during the same week. A lot of students struggle with work and preparation for all of their assignments without sacrificing personal time and activities, leading to procrastination or poor mental health. On top of this problem, part-time or full-time students have to find a way to manage their time around their jobs, which piles more stress on them.



Who

Students, teachers, employers



Product

In order to create an accessible solution for students who do not have time or cannot compile extensive study schedules, there can be a program through an app where students can have direct motivation to finish their assignments and prepare well for exams. Instead of having something like ECoach where students create their own schedules, previous successful students and GSIs should be able to share their study schedules for each project and exam on this app, and other students should be able to follow. The schedules should include practice problems, practice tests, and key ideas that cover the entire curriculum, and should be due each day of the week so students can finish the activities anytime throughout the day. For projects, the schedules should be set up such that the student has to complete one code file or one project checkpoint per day, so work is planned out for the student. GSIs who are in control of the app should be able to check up on students and answer questions directly on assignments. If someone forgets to do a project checkpoint, the app should continuously notify the student to complete the assignment as soon as possible, much like Canvas notifications but with a planned out study program for each specific assignment. Another key point of this app is collaboration between students. For students completing the same coursework, there should be a feature where students can request for other students to check their work once both students have their drafts done. Then each student can give short feedback and receive feedback to improve their assignments. At the final stage of each assignment, there should be a feature where students can get work checked by a GSI or IA, which would function like office hours where GSIs can set aside two or three days to just go over assignments rather than having meetings multiple times a week in person.



Features

This method would not only save both instructors and students time and extra travel, but could also lead to more information retention and performance improvement in courses. A lot of students currently spend the week before exams or projects trying to learn material, which leads to poor information retention after the class. But a structured approach where students can be exposed to the material everyday without them having to spend time looking for the material would lead to consistent learning and more information retention in the long-term. This app is heavily based on faculty and previous students, so it is important to note that in the development stages, there would need to be a lot of communication and assistance given from people who are not actively taking the class.



Conclusion

- Problem
- Solution

The biggest goal of this app would be to provide a way for students to have a more structured approach to their assignments and study goals, so that students do not have to have the added stress of checking Canvas for assignments, going to in-person office hours they cannot attend, trying to meet students after class outside of their busy schedules, and having to spend a lot of time planning out study schedules and which materials to go over for exams.



References

- Use the following resources:
- <https://www.cmu.edu/news/stories/archives/2021/october/active-learning.html>
- <https://news.harvard.edu/gazette/story/2019/09/study-shows-that-students-learn-more-when-taking-part-in-classrooms-that-employ-active-learning-strategies/>
- <https://www.pbs.org/newshour/education/can-just-time-advice-keep-college-students-track>
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Questions?